Elissa Huang

Product Designer · AI-Powered Experiences & Design Tools
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Professional Summary

Over the years, I've worked on large-scale consumer products, complex purchase experiences, and initiatives spanning multiple teams. What I've learned is that some of the most valuable opportunities lie between features and the teams building them, where disconnected decisions can create problems no single team owns.

Much of my work has focused on finding those connections and turning them into simpler, more scalable solutions. More recently, I've applied that same thinking to AI, building tools that reduce repetitive work and help teams work more effectively.

Selected Highlights

- Achieved **2×+ the typical service attachment rate** by leading end-to-end design of an **integrated grading experience** across 11 teams.
- Created **reusable service patterns** that aligned **6 product and functional areas** and became a shared reference across product categories.
- Reduced localization mockup time **from up to 1 week to ~10 minutes** by building **AI-powered Figma plugins** adopted across 6 product teams.
- Reduced repetitive design work with AI tools, including a project assistant that cut context-gathering time by an **estimated 90%** and an accessibility audit **estimated to reduce escalations by 80%**.

Skills

AI Experience Design: Model Uncertainty & Confidence States · Human-in-the-Loop Workflows · Classification with Human Review · Human Verification & Source Attribution · Feedback Loops for Model Improvement

AI Development & Tooling: Claude Code · Cursor · Claude Skills · Agent Harness Design · Algorithm vs. LLM Evaluation · MCP Integrations · Custom GPTs & Knowledge Files · Figma Plugin Development · AI-Assisted Testing · Synthetic Personas

Product Design: Interaction Design · Systems Thinking · Experience Architecture · Reusable Design Patterns · Cross-Platform Design · Visual Design · Rapid Prototyping · Figma

Research & Collaboration: Usability Testing · Workshop Facilitation · Cross-Functional Alignment · Design Critique · Mentoring

Professional Experience

eBay October 2016 – Present

Staff Product Designer

AI Tools & Design Enablement

- **Reduced project context-gathering time by an estimated 90%** by designing and building an **AI project assistant** (case study) that generates **source-linked briefs** covering project history, decisions, and dependencies. Integrated

Claude skills through MCP with Slack, Zoom, Outlook, and Google Drive, with verification steps to support reliable outputs. Used internally by the core design team.

- Reduced initial end-to-end service mockup time **from 1–2 days to ~5 minutes** in my own use by building **coded templates with Claude Code**. The templates cover the purchase journey from search results to order details, with a library of service variations for comparing content and visual treatments. Development is ongoing, with the goal of providing a shared foundation for other teams.
- Built an **AI design-skills toolkit** (case study) to help designers catch issues earlier, covering accessibility audits, handoff checks, Figma critiques, and mockup-to-code workflows. Developed the **underlying harness** using Claude Code and Cursor, grounding checks in eBay's accessibility standards and spot-checking results against manual reviews. Ambiguous decisions are returned to designers as Figma comments rather than resolved automatically.
- Estimated an **~80% reduction in issues escalated to the accessibility team** through the AI accessibility audit, which identifies problems before engineering handoff, including screen-reader reading-order issues that might otherwise go unreviewed. Shared the toolkit across eBay's design organization, with adoption by a few teams.
- Built **research-grounded synthetic personas** for early concept exploration using user research retrieved through MCP. Used them to examine different collector motivations, including social engagement and transaction-focused behavior, and surface questions for further user research rather than replace direct validation.
- Reduced localized mockup preparation **from up to 1 week to ~10 minutes** by building **Mock Translate**, an AI-powered Figma plugin. Also developed an amount calculator that automatically fills prices and totals across designs. Both tools have been **adopted by designers across 6 product teams**.

Frameworks & Systems

- Helped establish a **shared approach to trust signals** across product categories by co-developing a framework covering common principles, signal categories, and visual treatments. Building a **custom GPT classification assistant** with stress-tested definitions in knowledge files to assess program eligibility, reuse existing categories when appropriate, and flag potentially new categories for **human committee review**. Requesters can also appeal classifications to the committee.
- Developed a **cross-category design pattern** for adding services to multi-item carts, **aligning 6 product and functional areas**. Documented existing service presentation patterns in a **shared reference** used by teams across product categories.
- Identified inconsistencies across **7 pricing experiences**, uncovering 4 different sales-matching methods and 4 different headline prices. Facilitated a cross-team workshop that led to a **community of practice** with agreed ownership through RASCI, followed by product alignment on a **shared pricing data source**.
- Established **reusable guidance for pricing charts** covering tooltips, axis labels, data frequency, and full-number presentation that supports multiple languages.
- Defined a **cross-platform approach for multi-tier services** by developing a reusable pattern for presenting services with multiple configurations, establishing design direction for how buyers understand and compare their options.

Product Delivery

- **Achieved 2×+ the typical service attachment rate** by leading end-to-end design for integrated trading-card grading **across 11 teams**. Connected buyer and seller experiences spanning enrollment, checkout, tracking, and disputes, with an extensible enrollment structure that later accommodated additional service options.
- **Tripled grading attachment in offer-based purchases** by extending the service to purchase flows that bypass standard checkout.
- Established the **cross-platform foundation for Price Across Parallels**, a collectible pricing experience shared across scanning, item pages, and collections. Designed around image-recognition and sales-matching models developed by engineering and data science, working within their technical constraints.

  - Recommended using the **median of recent sales** to reduce the influence of outliers, gaining agreement from data science through the product manager.
  - Helped shape **confidence-based matching states** and designed a **price-accuracy feedback prompt** whose ratings are sent to data science for review.
  - In a survey of the broader product that reported **~90% satisfaction**, users identified Price Across Parallels as 1 of the features they used most.
- Designed eBay's **bulk listing tool** end to end, simplifying how sellers create and edit listings at scale. The tool remains in use and established a pattern for bulk editing at eBay.
- Aligned legal, shipping, and business partners on **buyer-side authentication** and managed shipping requirements, securing agreement on a design that simplifies how service information is communicated across buyer and seller touchpoints.
- Expanded a **collectible buyback concept** beyond its original use case by identifying opportunities across listing creation and other marketplace touchpoints. Developed exploratory designs that contributed to **approval of a standalone initiative**, now available to selected sellers.

AI-Built Products

Chinese Reading App for Kids

Independent product | Flutter · AI · OCR · Learning Algorithms

Designing and building a reading app (case study) that turns children's books into personalized Chinese reading lessons.

- Helped my 5-year-old learn **~50 Chinese characters in 1 month** using lessons generated from the first book. They can now read almost the entire book independently, while my 3-year-old can navigate the lessons without assistance.
- Built a lesson-generation workflow using OCR to extract text and an algorithm to determine the teaching sequence. Developed a comparison tool to test different ordering settings and **evaluated the algorithm against Claude**. After finding comparable quality, **retained the algorithm** rather than introducing unnecessary AI dependency. Parents can review and edit lessons.
- Designed a data model that accommodates traditional and simplified Chinese after **rejecting an AI-generated proposal** that treated both scripts as a 1-to-1 mapping. Used separate dictionaries keyed by pronunciation, with a linking table to account for script and regional pronunciation differences.
- Designed the learning experience for young children, using pictures rather than text-heavy instructions, oversized touch targets, karaoke-style reading guidance, no penalties for mistakes, and rewards. Observed **38 short learning sessions in 1 sitting**.
- Created an **AI-assisted asset and testing workflow**, using ChatGPT for character design, an agent-assisted process to turn static illustrations into Rive animations, and AI-assisted regression tests.

Backgammon Rounds

Independent product | Flutter · Claude Code

- Designed, built, and **published a mobile backgammon game on the App Store and Google Play** using Flutter and Claude Code in VS Code. Implemented the game rules and a custom computer opponent with 3 difficulty levels.

Talks, Workshops & Community

- Led AI workflow workshops and demonstrations attended by **50+ people** at eBay, sharing approaches to AI-assisted design workflows and the design-skills toolkit.

- Mentored junior designers, led design critiques, and facilitated working sessions with product and engineering partners.
- Facilitated a cross-team pricing workshop that led to a community of practice with defined ownership.

Earlier Experience

Yahoo April 2014 – October 2016

Senior Interaction Designer

Designed interfaces and interaction flows for internal advertising publishing tools, simplifying complex publishing workflows.

Education

Bachelor of Science · Simon Fraser University